



DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

Course Report: Master's Thesis (SK2532), fall 2024 and spring 2025

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The course Master's Thesis is an in-depth course in Political Science. The thesis is the degree project for a Master's degree in Political Science or a Master's degree in Political Science: Environmental Governance and Behavior. The course is compulsory within MAPS and MAPSE. The course is placed at the spring semester the second year of the two Master's programmes, but it is possible for students to instead write their thesis during the fall semester of the second year. This report covers the fall semester 2024 and the spring semester 2025. During the course the students write an independent, in-depth scientific thesis and defend it orally at a mandatory seminar. The teaching on the course differs from many other courses in the sense that most of the work is done independently by the student. The teaching mainly comes in the form of individual supervision. Before the course starts, the students are in contact with the course coordinator who helps students to find a supervisor and provide early feedback on their research projects. There were two voluntary feedback seminars: one in November 2024 (before the course started) and one in February 2025. During these seminars the students got feedback on their work from the course coordinator as well as from other students. The course ends with mandatory thesis seminars, where the students present their thesis and discuss another student's thesis.

The most significant change in this iteration of the course was the reduction of the word limit from 20,000 to 16,000 words, effective from the fall semester of 2024.

During fall 2024/spring 2025, 69 students were registered on the course (of which 24 students had re-registered). Of the 69, 52 had completed the course by the end of 2025. 36 students received the grade Pass (G) and 16 students Pass with Distinction (VG).

The students were asked to fill in the course evaluation after the course was completed. 22 students responded (34%). The results for the survey are reported below alongside the results from previous years. It is worth noting that most students evaluated the course very positively: 46% rated it *Very good* and another 46% rated it *Rather good*. No students rated the course as *Rather bad* or *Very bad*.

Survey responses:

Overall, how would you assess the course?						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Very good	3 (17,6%)	3 (37,5%)	6 (37,5%)	2 (22,2%)	3 (17,6%)	10 (45.5%)
Rather good	13 (76,5%)	4 (50,0%)	8 (50,0%)	6 (66,7%)	11 (64,7%)	10 (45.5%)
Neither good nor bad	1 (5,9%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (6,2%)	1 (11,1%)	2 (11,8%)	2 (9.1%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (6,2%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)	1 (12,5%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (5,9%)	0 (0.0%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)

Overall, how would you assess the supervision of the thesis?						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Very good	4 (23,5%)	3 (37,5%)	8 (50,0%)	5 (55,6%)	7 (41,2%)	17 (77.3%)
Rather good	9 (52,9%)	4 (50,0%)	5 (31,2%)	1 (11,1%)	6 (35,3%)	3 (13.6%)
Neither good nor bad	3 (17,6%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (6,2%)	1 (11,1%)	1 (5,9%)	0 (0.0%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	2 (12,5%)	2 (22,2%)	2 (11,8%)	1 (4.5%)
Very bad	1 (5,9%)	1 (12,5%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (5,9%)	1 (4.5%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)

Overall, how would you assess the examination seminars? (Note: in 2020 and 2021 the question was "Overall, how would you assess the seminars?")						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Very good	6 (35,3%)	1 (12,5%)	3 (18,8%)	5 (55,6%)	6 (35,3%)	7 (31.8%)
Rather good	4 (23,5%)	4 (50,0%)	8 (50,0%)	2 (22,2%)	4 (23,5%)	13 (59.1%)
Neither good nor bad	7 (41,2%)	2 (25,0%)	3 (18,8%)	1 (11,1%)	7 (41,2%)	2 (9.1%)
Rather bad	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	2 (12,5%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)	1 (12,5%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (11,1%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)

How would you assess the organization of the course, including the information on Canvas (information, schedule, administration)?						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Very good	6 (35,3%)	4 (50,0%)	7 (43,8%)	5 (55,6%)	8 (47,1%)	11 (50.0%)
Rather good	7 (41,2%)	3 (37,5%)	3 (18,8%)	3 (33,3%)	4 (23,5%)	6 (27.3%)
Neither good nor bad	3 (17,6%)	0 (0,0%)	5 (31,2%)	0 (0,0%)	5 (29,4%)	5 (22.7%)
Rather bad	1 (5,9%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (11,1%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Very bad	0 (0,0%)	1 (12,5%)	1 (6,2%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)

What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Much too demanding	0 (0,0%)	1 (12,5%)	0 (0,0%)	2 (22,2%)	1 (5,9%)	1 (4.5%)
Somewhat too demanding	2 (11,8%)	0 (0,0%)	2 (12,5%)	4 (44,4%)	4 (23,5%)	3 (13.6%)
OK	12 (70,6%)	5 (62,5%)	12 (75%)	2 (22,2%)	10 (58,8%)	17 (77.3%)
Not that demanding	3 (17,6%)	2 (25,0%)	2 (12,5%)	1 (11,1%)	2 (11,8%)	1 (4.5%)
Not at all demanding	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)

On average, approximately how much time do you spend on coursework, both in and outside of the classroom, per week?						
	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Less than 10 hours	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (11,1%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0.0%)
11-20 hours	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (6,2%)	0 (0,0%)	0 (0,0%)	1 (4.5%)
21-30 hours	4 (23,5%)	2 (25,0%)	5 (31,2%)	2 (22,2%)	7 (41,2%)	4 (18.2%)
31-40 hours	8 (47,1%)	5 (62,5%)	6 (37,5%)	3 (33,3%)	5 (29,4%)	14 (63.6%)
More than 40 hours	5 (29,4%)	1 (12,5%)	4 (25,0%)	3 (33,3%)	5 (29,4%)	3 (13.6%)
Total	17 (100,0%)	8 (100,0%)	16 (100,0%)	9 (100,0%)	17 (100,0%)	22 (100.0%)